

Week 07

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Concept Sketches

My first sketch I started with a simple timeline showing how I use my phone during the day. Each time I use my phone becomes a coloured block, and each colour shows how I was feeling (blue = tired, yellow = happy, red = stressed, grey = neutral).

I added notes like:

- I use my phone more when I'm tired at night
- Short bursts might mean boredom or distraction
- Longer use could link to stress or avoidance
- Patterns might appear over time

Feedback I Received

What people noticed:

- Colours make emotions easy to read quickly
- It looks like a rhythm or pattern
- It feels personal, not just data

Questions people asked:

- How do you know the emotion at the time?
- Can one session have more than one feeling?
- What if you forget to log emotions?

What I changed after feedback

- I realised I needed a simpler and more realistic way of tracking emotions.

So I adjusted my idea:

- Fewer, clearer emotion categories
- Split longer sessions if feelings change

- Add "neutral/unknown" option
- Focus more on patterns than accuracy

Making Sprint - Quick Prototype

What I made I created a simple spreadsheet tracking one day of phone use:

- Time
- App used
- Duration
- Emotion

Then I turned it into a coloured timeline.

What I was trying to test

I wanted to see if emotions could actually be shown clearly using colour over time.

What I found

- Colour works really well and is easy to read
- Even one day shows clear patterns
- Late-night use stands out strongly
- Emotional gaps are also meaningful

But:

- Emotions are still hard to define clearly
- Some moments feel oversimplified
- I need better rules for logging emotions

"What If" Variations

Original idea

- A simple timeline with coloured emotional blocks.

Chosen variation: layered emotions

- Instead of separate blocks, emotions overlap and build up over time.

What this changes

- Before: one block = one emotion
- Now: emotions mix and build up
- Before: structured and clear
- Now: more like a mood “atmosphere”

What this opens up

- Feels more realistic emotionally
- More expressive and artistic
- Shows emotional build-up over time
- Less like a chart, more like a feeling

Progress Reports

I wasn't able to attend the progress report session, so I didn't receive direct feedback from presenting my project. Because of this, I reflected more on my earlier research, previous discussions, and how my project has changed through testing and development.

The biggest thing I realised is that my project is stronger when it focuses on emotions rather than only phone usage data. The goal of my project is to visualise how emotions influence phone habits over time, and through reflection I realised that this emotional connection is what makes the project more meaningful and relatable.

Another important realisation was around complexity. Earlier versions of my idea included layered emotions and more complicated interactions, but I noticed that as the system became more complex, it became harder to understand visually. Because of this, I decided that readability and clarity should be prioritised over complexity.

I also realised that my project is less about measuring behaviour perfectly and more about encouraging reflection. Instead of creating an exact representation of phone habits, I want the visualisation to help users recognise emotional patterns they may not normally notice.

Moving forward, I want to continue developing a simple timeline-based visual system that clearly communicates emotional patterns while remaining easy to understand and interact with.

Project Development and Skill Building

What I worked on

- I focused on improving the emotional timeline by simplifying how emotions are organised and displayed.

I experimented with creating small datasets using timestamps, phone sessions, duration, and emotional categories. I simplified emotional tracking by assigning one main emotion to each session instead of using multiple overlapping emotions.

I also tested different colour systems to see which emotions were easiest to recognise visually and whether patterns became clearer over time.

What I learned

- Simpler emotional categories make patterns easier to recognise
- Too much information can make the visual confusing
- Colour is an effective way to communicate emotion quickly
- Organising data clearly makes building the visual system much easier

Technical skills developed

- Organising time-based datasets
- Creating consistent emotional categories
- Using colour to communicate information clearly
- Testing how interaction might work within a timeline

How this moved the project forward

This stage helped me move away from trying to build a complicated system and toward creating something more focused. I now have a clearer direction that prioritises emotional readability, self-reflection, and making behavioural patterns easy for users to recognise.